

KELLOGG SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT KELLOGG

The Kellogg School of Management is part of Northwestern University, located in Evanston about 12 miles north of downtown Chicago. The beautiful lakeside location in a thriving student town is a big part of the Kellogg culture, with time to cultivate strong ties with classmates that is so much part of the school's close-knit community. The collaborative learning style of the MBA program reinforces these ties, with a heavy emphasis on teamwork - 'we' rather than 'I.'

Stereotyped as the school for marketing, Kellogg is in fact so much more. So why does McKinsey recruit more Kellogg MBAs than any other U.S. school? Because they have humility, great analytical skills, and the people skills that mean they can be client facing from day one.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

*Marketing, general management, non-profit/social responsibility,
production/operations, strategy, entrepreneurship, healthcare,
consumer goods*

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021
BusinessWeek	8	8	10	10	*
Financial Times	12	12	14	11	6
Forbes	4	-	3	-	-
The Economist	1	2	4	-	*
US News	4	6	6	3	4

CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	5,813	Avg Age	27
MBA Class Size	559	Avg GMAT	727
Admissions selectivity	27.9%	Avg GPA	3.6
Yield	34.47%	Int'l Students	26%
Total Tuition	US\$149,742	Female Students	40%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2020)

Consulting	36%
Technology	28%
Financial Services	15%
Consumer Products	7%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

McKinsey, Bain, BCG, Amazon, Apple, Accenture, Google, Deloitte Consulting, Strategy&, Adobe Systems, Microsoft, , Wayfair, Tyson Foods, Oak Street Health, Visa

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$144,000

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 94%

**Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.*



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR KELLOGG APPLICATION

BY WILLIAM KOTAS

A Kellogg alumnus, Willie's dedication to serving others began with a two-year stint in the Peace Corps. His involvement with Kellogg never paused upon his graduation; he led alumni clubs in Peru, South Florida, and Brazil, was honored as Kellogg's worldwide alumni volunteer of the year in 2011, Willie met individually with hundreds of high potentials considering MBA or EMBA studies, offering them unique insight into what Kellogg and competing top tier programs seek in candidates.



Almost every aspect of the application has some component geared toward understanding if a student is the right cultural fit.

1

PLAY TO YOUR STRENGTHS...EVEN IF THEY SEEM CONVENTIONAL

Kellogg prides itself on building a truly diverse class across lots of dimensions. One of the signature traditions during orientation is for the Dean of Admissions to give a speech called “One of You” that runs down a list of remarkable highlights about new students. Admissions officers take great pride in identifying candidates who have really self-reflected on what they want and how Kellogg will get them there. The key is to embrace your genuine story even if it seems entirely normal – failing to do so trips up more applicants than you can imagine. If you’ve taken a traditional path in banking because that’s your interest, then own that. After all, an entire class can’t be filled by Peace Corps workers who started their own microfinance funds and sing professionally on the side. And if you try to spice up your application with details or stories that read falsely, officers will sniff them out immediately.

DIFFERENTIATE YOURSELF BASED ON YOUR CONVENTIONS

2

Kellogg has become so diverse that more conventional paths can stand out. This is particularly true if you’re coming from finance with plans to potentially stay in that industry or make a pivot from, say, private equity to investment banking. There is concern in some quarters that the program has embraced the poets at the expense of the quants. While this reflects a shift amongst the applicant pool (and the broader decline of interest in finance as the prestige MBA path), the school is very much attuned to applicants with a linear story and exceptional quant skills.

3

TELL A GOOD STORY

This doesn't mean embellish. Quite the opposite, the advice here is to aim for consistency in putting together your application with clear threads throughout. You definitely want to aim high, but make sure the supporting elements are solid. Do your essays and letters of recommendation define a similar vision? Do your letters of recommendation and interview paint a similar portrait? Do your undergrad experiences line up with your essays? Candidates can sometimes get a little carried away, which leads to big dreams that don't seem based in any previous experiences.

RECOGNIZE THAT CULTURE MATTERS – AND KNOW WHAT THAT MEANS

4

As the Kellogg culture has become more deeply ingrained, the need to preserve it has heightened. Officers feel a real sense of obligation to protect what makes the school unique. Almost every aspect of the application has some component geared toward understanding if a student is the right fit. So what exactly does this culture of collaboration entail? Dean Blount expresses it as impact without ego, and that's about as good a definition as exists. Another way to think about the culture is like this: the program will force you to work in team settings constantly. Most people can be dependable peers for an hour at a time. But what if you're in hour 12 of an intense case analysis? Do you still have the maturity to be just as diplomatic as in hour 1? A strong applicant will show strong situational awareness and examples of how they can work in lots of different types of teams.

5

HAVE A VIABLE ALTERNATIVE

Perhaps the most oft-cited critique or question from a Kellogg officer: “does this person have a plan b?” That’s another way of saying that the story didn’t quite come together and that the ending in particular is concerning. In the high-stakes rankings game, Kellogg has done well in large part with the employment record of a large percentage of its graduates. The careers staff do a phenomenal job in working with students, but they also don’t want to have to take unnecessary risks. To tie this all together with the other tips, if you’re plan is to start your own company but you have no entrepreneurship anywhere in your background and your recommenders say you’re risk-averse, you need to display a viable alternative. And at a school in which competition for a position in consulting is fierce, working for Bain, BCG or McKinsey in order to “round out your experiences and get exposed to lots of different industries” is not a solid backup.

For more insider insights into Kellogg please
visit the [Fortuna Blog](#).

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION NOTIFICATION
Round 1	15 September 2021	08 December 2021
Round 2	05 January 2022	22 March 2022
Round 3	06 April 2022	11 May 2022



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

